

CONCUSSION

A word that has become increasingly familiar to the public, especially since Cricket, a sport historically resistant to substitution, introduced the Concussion Substitute rule. Yet, concussion has long been a persistent threat to athletes worldwide, particularly in brutal contact sports like American football, association football, boxing, etc which involves helmet-helmet or head to ball or head to fist contacts.

A concussion occurs when a forceful blow to the head or body jolts the brain, causing it to rapidly move back and forth inside the skull. While imaging tests like CT scans and MRIs often don't show visible damage, this jarring impact can damage the deep brain cells and disrupt normal function. Contrary to popular belief, losing consciousness isn't a prerequisite for a concussion; in fact, only 10% of concussion cases involve loss of consciousness.



PHYSICAL SYMPTOMS

Headache, Dizziness, Nausea Blurred Vision, Fatigue, etc

COGNITIVE SYMPTOMS

Trouble Concentrating, Confusion, Forgetfulness and Emotional Instability

WHEN CONCUSSED STOP PLAYING IMMEDIATELY

REST BOTH PHYSICALLY AND MENTALLY | MONITOR BREATHING AND PULSE

The more concussions you get, the more likely you are to suffer long-term consequences, especially if you don't give your brain enough time to heal between injuries. The best example would be the case of boxing legend Muhamad Ali, who was diagnosed with Parkinson's, chiefly due to the repeated blows that he suffered during his illustrious boxing career.

LONG TERM EFFECTS

Neurodegenerative Diseases, Cognitive impairments, Behavioral changes, etc

While advancements in medical science and equipment have mitigated the long-term effects of concussion to some extent, the risk remains a significant concern in many contact sports. While we can't alter their essence, prioritising preventive measures are crucial in safe-guarding athlete's long term brain health

Halt Sports Injuries (HSI) : An Ortho One Initiative which creates awareness through learning session and medical support at subsidised amount for deserving sports person.

(Note: Donations are exempt under 80(G) and CSR Income Tax act)